Teacher and cover plan

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 1 Week 1 Thursday 7 January 2027 P1 Year A

A balanced meal on a budget

Weekly outcome verbatim: FOODWISE: plan a balanced meal on a budget.

LAUNCH Weekly Spring row 197. Year A. Theme Resilience & Change. One 40-minute lesson for a small LAUNCH group aged 14–16.

The pupil designs one meal within a £2.00 invented ingredient-use budget. Keep a completed plan and the pupil’s one-line justification. Today is planning. No food preparation, shopping or tasting is needed.

Prepare

Display the HTML or slides. Have the budget card, balanced plate recap, meal prompts and one tier available. Use books first. A calculator is optional. No ingredients or sharp tools are needed today.

Read the kitchen card and adult readiness check before Week 2. Arrange actual label, dietary, storage, equipment and supervision checks then. Keep these separate from today’s planning judgement.

Timing

Stage	Minutes
Arrival	5
Starter	3
I do	5
We do	7
We do 2	5
Independent	8
Review	4
Exit	3

Total 40 minutes. Three brief resets are included inside Arrival, Independent and Review; they do not extend the lesson. All models, cards and tier tasks fit inside these stages.

The brief and balanced eating

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Arrival 5 minutes

Say and do: Read the brief aloud. Ask what the meal must do: offer variety, cost no more than £2.00 and be possible in a short supervised practical. Explain that the prices are invented and no one needs to discuss home spending. Offer spoken planning or a private adult check. Use the last minute as a quiet settling reset.

Check and response: Ask: Whose meal and what limit? Expect one person and £2.00. Re-read the brief if either is missing.

Starter 3 minutes

Say and do: Use the balanced plate recap. Invite food group sorting, with the model meal as an example rather than a rule for every meal. Explain that protein is a nutrient in several foods; beans are counted in the protein group for this model to avoid double counting. Oils are used in small amounts when needed, not added to tick a box.

Check and response: Wrap is starchy food; beans supply protein; carrot is a vegetable. Fruit adds variety and yoghurt adds dairy. Read the recap again if pupils use only colour as a test of balance.

Modelling and shared costing

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 1 Week 1 Thursday 7 January 2027 P1 Year A

I do 5 minutes

Say and do: Point to each amount and price. Add 35p + 30p + 15p + 10p + 20p + 30p = 140p, or £1.40. Then £2.00 minus £1.40 = £0.60. Name the food groups and model the one-line reason. Explain the three recipe steps using empty-hand gestures only. No food or sharp tools are needed today. Fade the model by asking pupils to supply the final addition.

Check and response: Ask: Is 140p £1.40 or £14.00? Expect £1.40. Show 100p plus 40p and repeat the check if needed.

We do 7 minutes

Say and do: Calculate the change together: £1.40 minus £0.30 plus £0.35 = £1.45. The budget left is 55p. Record why fruit is still present. Read the price basis and distinguish a portion cost from a full pack price. Ask a pupil to explain the method to a partner or adult. Keep household finances private.

Check and response: Accept £1.45 and 55p. If the old item is still charged, cross it out, subtract it and add the replacement once.

Hinge check and independent planning

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 1 Week 1 Thursday 7 January 2027 P1 Year A

We do 2 5 minutes

Say and do: Use the hinge choices. Correct answer is 60p because 200p minus 140p equals 60p. If any learner chooses another answer, rehearse with written pence amounts before independent work. Parallel check: a £1.55 meal leaves 45p. Also ask why ready-to-eat beans matter and why a grater needs approval. No tasting or preparation takes place today.

Check and response: Move on when pupils can show subtraction or explain the budget comparison. If not, use the Supported route with paired checking and keep the independent evidence pupil-owned.

Independent 8 minutes

Say and do: Use the meal plan prompts and one route. Pupils may use the model ingredients but make and explain their own choice. An adult can scribe the pupil’s words and read them back. Check food groups, arithmetic and a feasible dish. A different dish needs a checked two- or three-step method, suitable ingredients and adult approval before practical use. Use the last minute to pause, review the list and organise the book.

Check and response: The core evidence is an ingredient list with quantities, total at or below £2.00 and a one-line balanced-meal reason. Note an unfinished plan honestly. Record support used.

Review and next practical

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 1 Week 1 Thursday 7 January 2027 P1 Year A

Review 4 minutes

Say and do: Offer a partner check by consent or an adult check. The pupil makes one correction if needed. The adult marks next-week readiness as approved or pending after checking method, ingredients, dietary needs and equipment. Keep tasting optional. Use the final minute for a calm tidy reset. Do not label an unmade dish as completed.

Check and response: Use the evidence sheet. A balanced meal within budget meets the planning task; practical approval is a separate safety gate.

Exit 3 minutes

Say and do: Ask each pupil for their own cost and reason, privately if preferred. Retain the plan in the book and record the page. Keep any unresolved dietary or equipment checks pending. Week 2 uses the agreed plan. This week provides planning evidence only.

Check and response: Accept exact confirmed scribing, oral explanation linked to the plan, or independent writing. Keep actual evidence separate from the adult model.

Materials free fallback

Without food, equipment, printer or paper, read the price rows aloud. Pupils speak, sign or direct their ingredient choices. Rehearse the three steps with empty hands. An adult records exact choices, total and reason when a recording method is available. Mark transcription pending until it exists. This is planning or simulation, never a claim that the meal was prepared.

Access support and future use

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 1 Week 1 Thursday 7 January 2027 P1 Year A

Cognition and Learning

Show one step at a time. Read the price card aloud. Model an addition, then leave the next one for the pupil. Use pence throughout before converting to pounds. Offer a calculator and a repeated checklist.

Communication and Interaction

Accept pointing, speech, signing or pupil-directed scribing. Give thinking time and a brief choice before an open question. Read the final plan back so the pupil can correct it.

SEMH

Use invented prices and a fictional design brief. No home spending, body, weight or personal diet disclosures. Avoid good-food or bad-food labels. Offer a private adult review and a calm pause with an agreed return.

Sensory and Physical

No food handling or tasting is required today. Provide a clear large-print view. Offer pre-prepared vegetables and adult tool handling for the later practical. Plan a suitable route before any food is issued.

EAL

Plan in any language. Pair ingredient names with the price row and food group. Read quantities and money aloud. Use the pupil’s own words with confirmed translation or scribing where available.

Prompt ladder

Point to the place or instruction. Ask a short question. Rephrase. Offer a scaffold or choice. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Where this leads

Food designers and catering teams balance cost, nutrition, access and safe preparation. A clear plan helps another person prepare the intended meal.